

Machine Learning for Business Analytics

GTSC2143

Lecture 1 Introduction

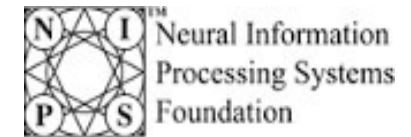
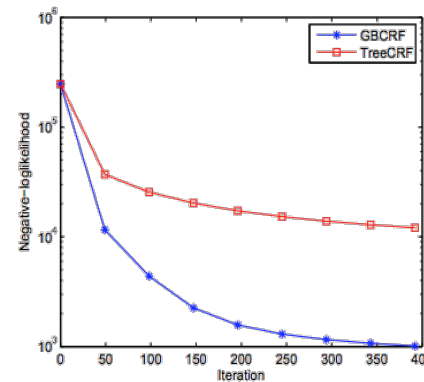
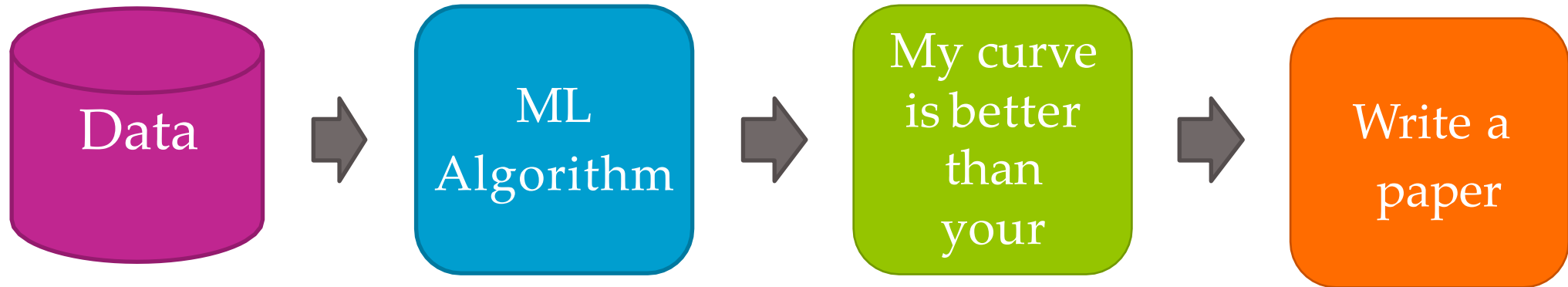
Instructor: Dr. Lily Bei Luo

AY2025-2026 Semester 1

Section 1 Introduction to Machine Learning

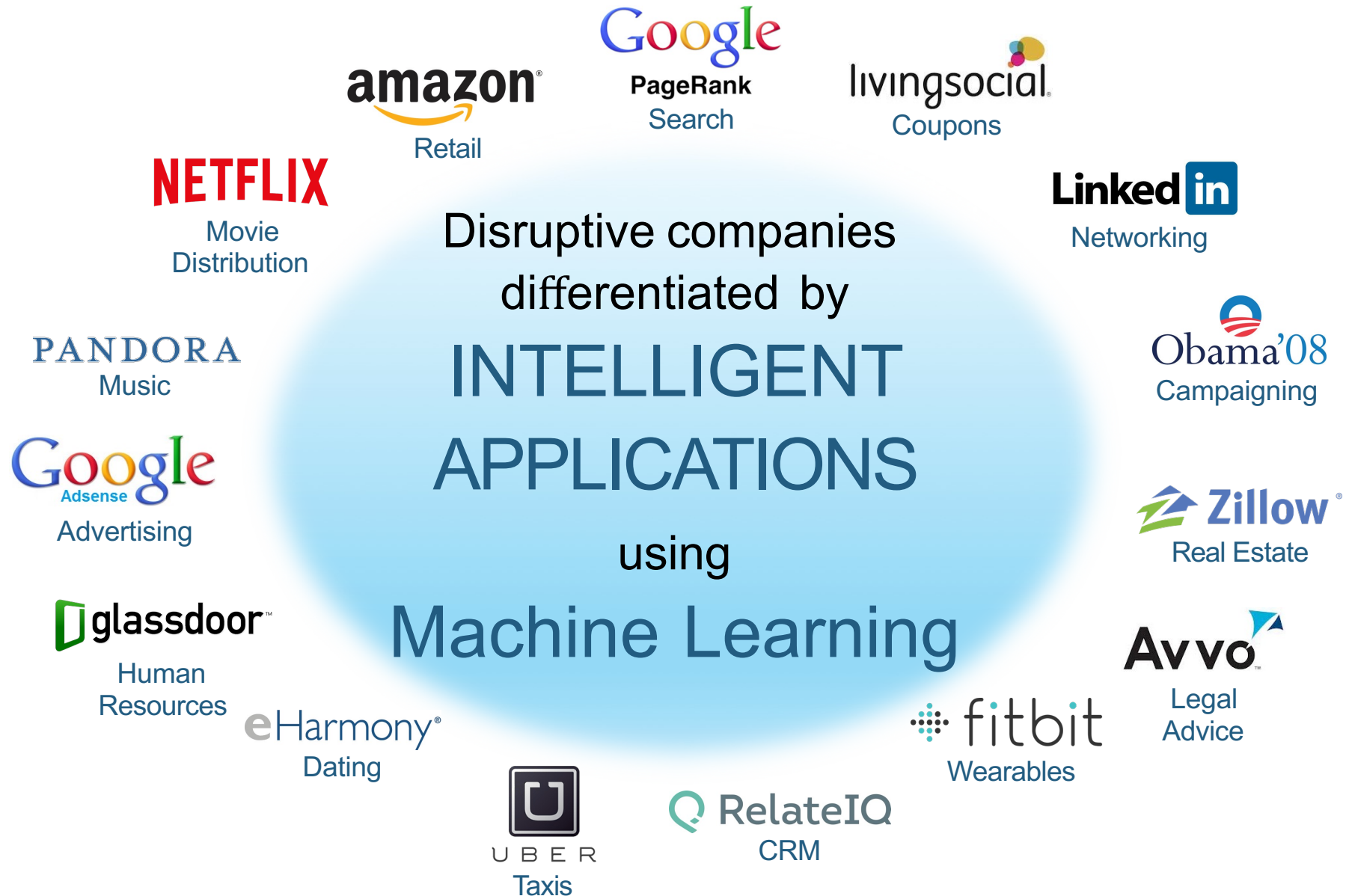
Machine learning is
changing the world

The Past of Machine Learning

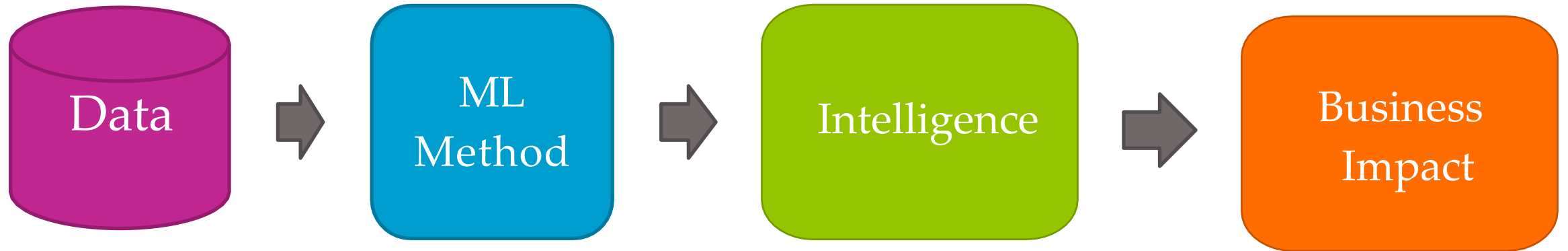


ICML

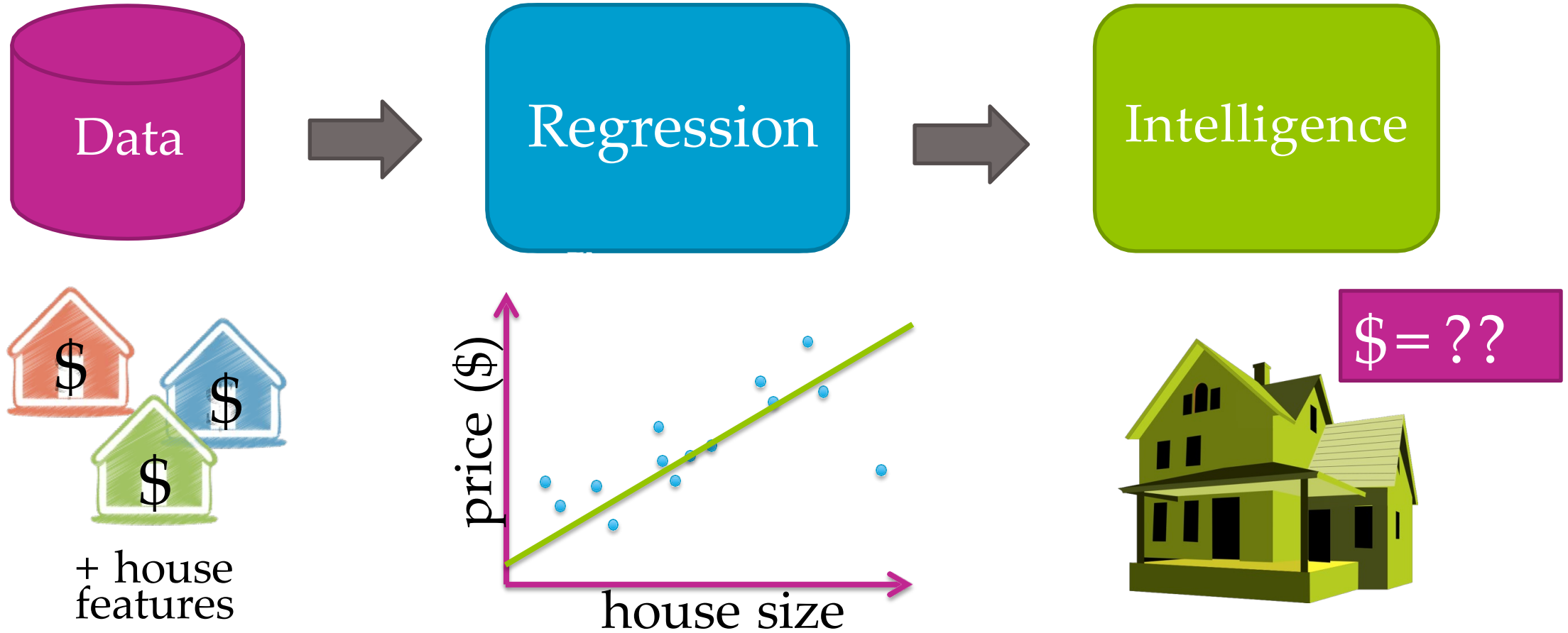
Intelligent Applications



The Present of Machine Learning



Case Study 1: Predicting house prices

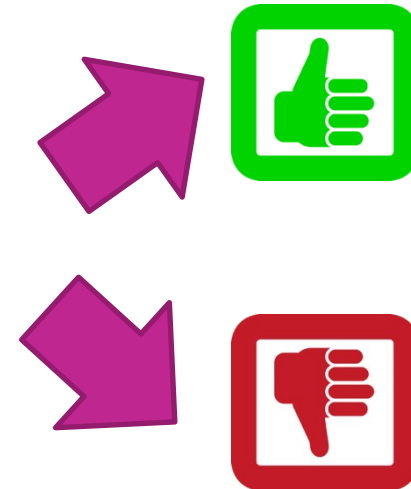
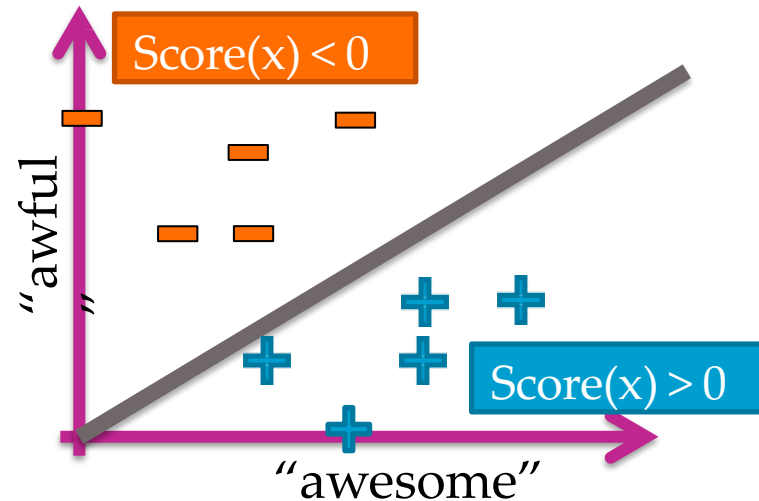


Case Study 2: Sentiment analysis

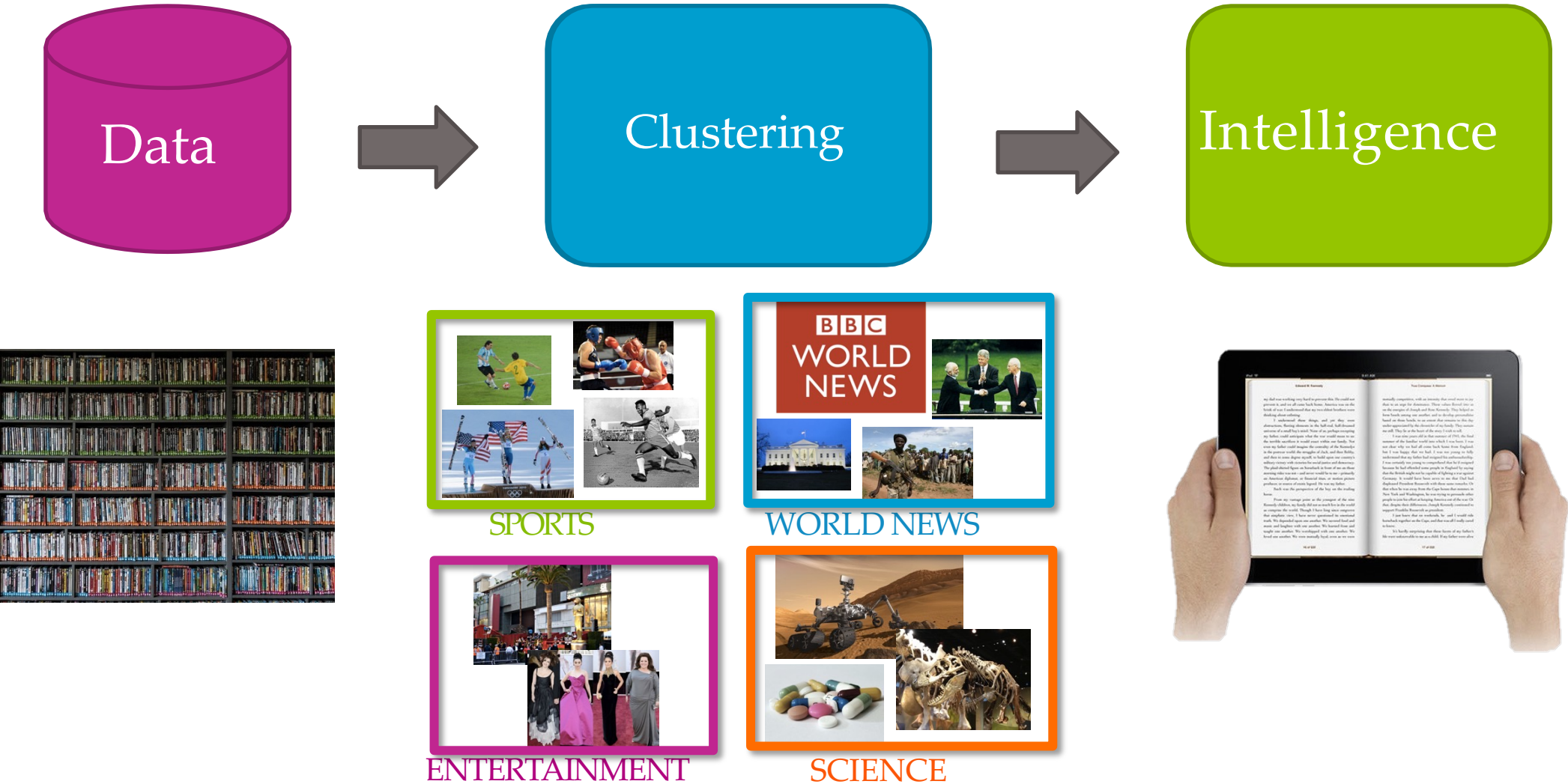


Sushi was awesome, the food was awesome, but the service was awful.

All reviews:



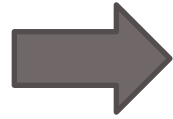
Case Study 3: Document retrieval



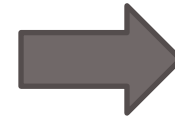
Case Study 4: Product recommendation



Data



ML
Method



Intelligence

Your past
purchases:



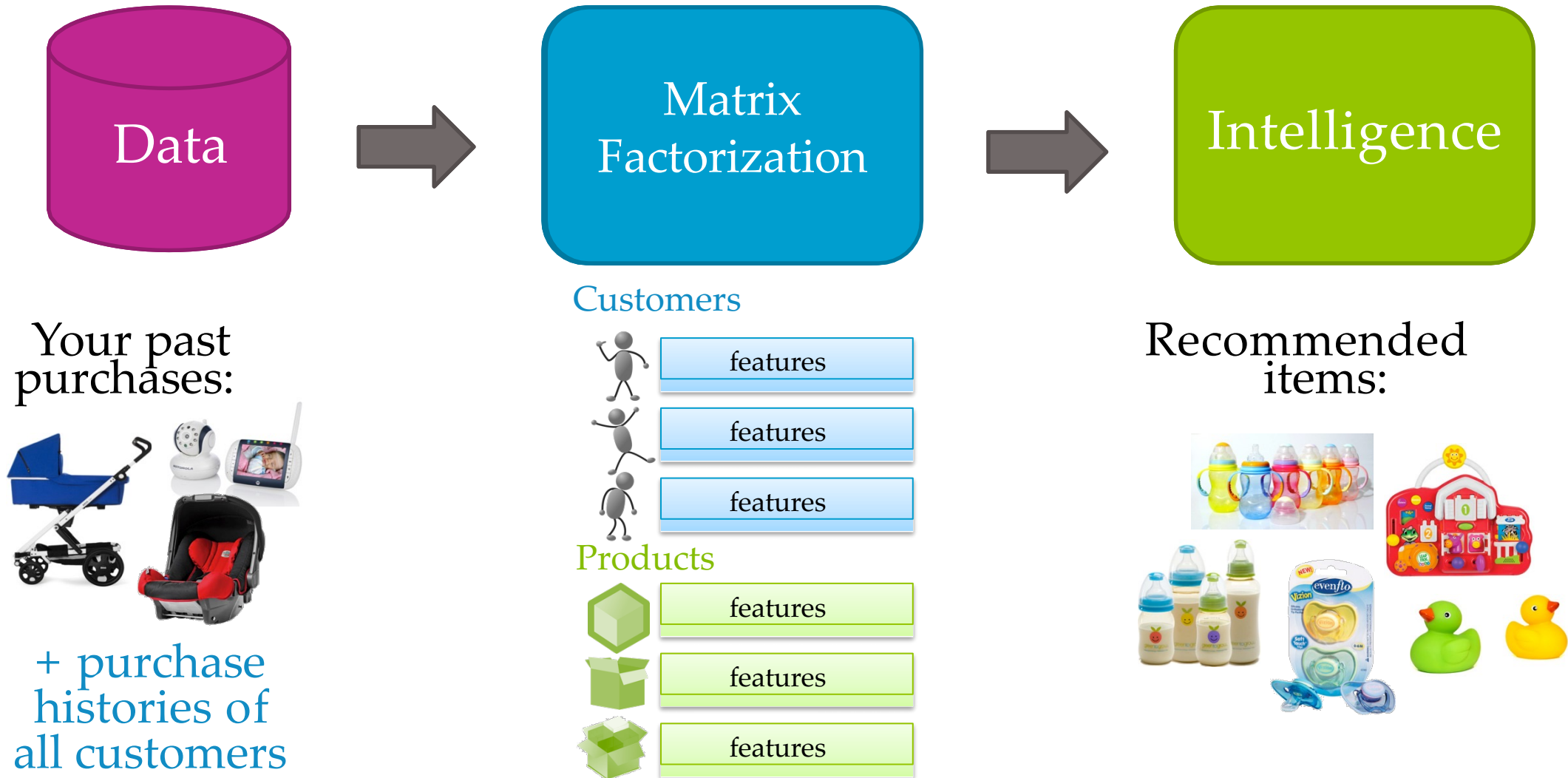
+ purchase
histories of
all customers



Recommended
items:



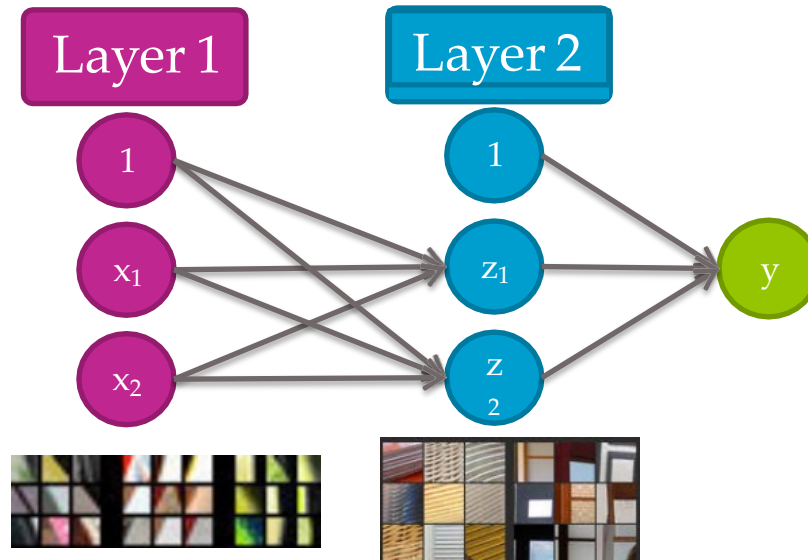
Case Study 4: Product recommendation



Case Study 5: Visual product recommender



Input images:



Nearest neighbors:



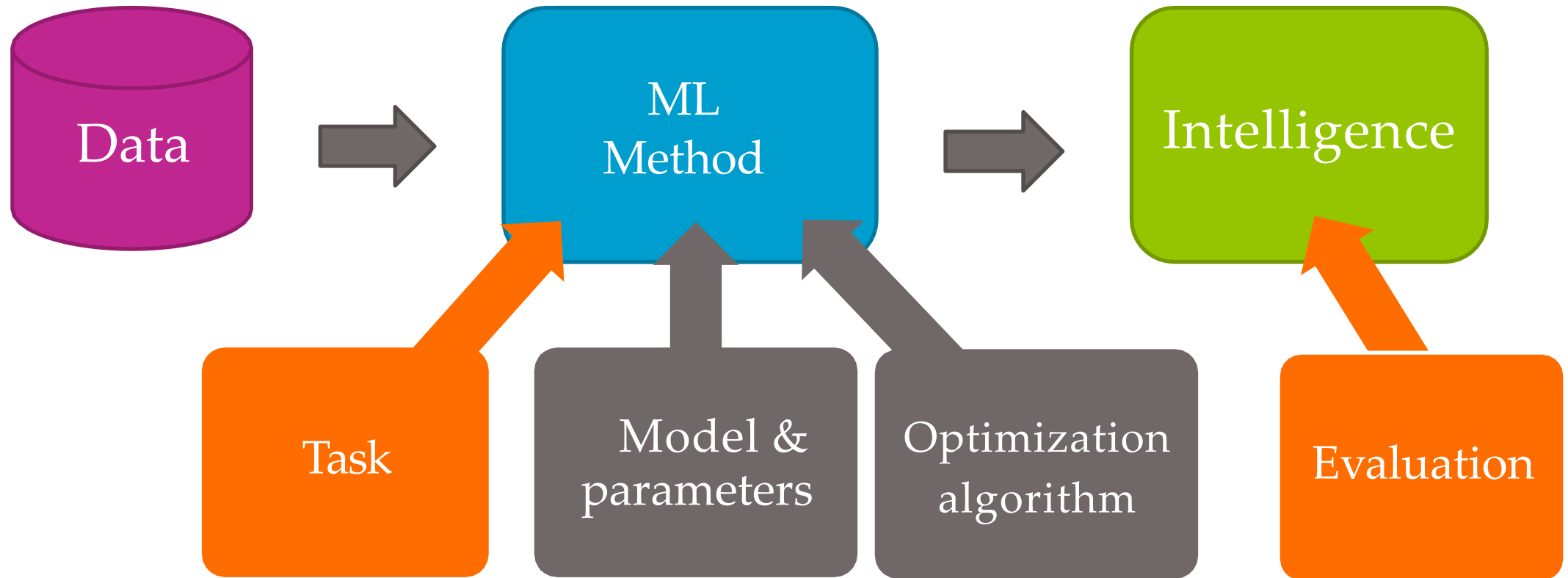
Case Study Approach

Not like other ML
courses out there...

From use cases to models
& algorithms

Case Study Approach

Our course is about building, evaluating
and deploying *intelligence in each case study...*



Section 2 Python Basics

Why Python?

- Python is a widely used, versatile programming language ideal for business analytics and data science applications.
- Easy to start working with, making it accessible for business professionals and analysts without extensive programming backgrounds.
- Powerful data analysis and statistical computation capabilities similar to R and SAS, with extensive libraries for business intelligence.
- Supported by major machine learning frameworks such as scikit-learn, pandas, and NumPy, which are essential for business analytics workflows.

Jupyter Notebook / Google Colab

- Jupyter Notebook

- A Jupyter notebook lets you write and execute Python code locally in your web browser
- Interactive, code re-execution, result storage, can interleave text, equations, and images
- Can add conda environments to Jupyter notebook

- Google Colab

- <https://colab.research.google.com/>
- Google's hosted Jupyter notebook service, runs in the cloud, requires no setup to use, provides free access to computing resources including GPUs
- Comes with many Python libraries pre-installed

Language Basics

Common Operations

<code>x = 10</code>		<code># Declaring two integer variables</code>
<code>y = 3</code>		<code># Comments start with hash</code>
<code>x + y</code>	<code>>> 13</code>	<code># Arithmetic operations</code>
<code>x ** y</code>	<code>>> 1000</code>	<code># Exponentiation</code>
<code>x / y</code>	<code>>> 3</code>	<code># Dividing two integers</code>
<code>x / float(y)</code>	<code>>> 3.333...</code>	<code># Type casting for float division</code>
<code>str(x) + "+"</code> <code>+ str(y)</code>	<code>>> "10 + 3"</code>	<code># Casting integer as string and string concatenation</code>

Language Basics

Built-in Values

`True, False`

`# Usual true/false values`

`None`

`# Represents the absence of something`

`x = None`

`# Variables can be assigned None`

`array = [1, 2, None]`

`# Lists can contain None`

`def func():`

`# Functions can return None`

`return None`

Language Basics

Built-in Values

```
and          # Boolean operators in Python written
or           as plain English
not

if [] != [None]:    # Comparison operators == and !=
    print("Not equal")  check for equality/inequality, return
                        true/false values
```

Language Basics

Collections: List

Lists are **mutable arrays**.

```
names = ['Zach', 'Jay']
names[0] == 'Zach'
names.append('Richard')
print(len(names) == 3) >> True
print(names) >> ['Zach', 'Jay', 'Richard']
names += ['Abi', 'Kevin']
print(names) >> ['Zach', 'Jay', 'Richard', 'Abi', 'Kevin']
names = [] # Creates an empty list
names = list() # Also creates an empty list
stuff = [1, ['hi', 'bye'], -0.12, None] # Can mix types
```

Language Basics

List Slicing

List elements can be accessed in convenient ways.

Basic format: `some_list[start_index:end_index]`

```
numbers = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
numbers[0:3] == numbers[:3] == [0, 1, 2]
numbers[5:] == numbers[5:7] == [5, 6]
numbers[:] == numbers == [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
numbers[-1] == 6 # Negative index wraps around
numbers[-3:] == [4, 5, 6]
numbers[3:-2] == [3, 4] # Can mix and match
```

Language Basics

Collections: Tuples

Tuples are **immutable arrays**.

```
names = ('Zach', 'Jay') # Note the parentheses
names[0] == 'Zach'
print(len(names) == 2) >> True
print(names) >> ('Zach', 'Jay')
names[0] = 'Richard' >> TypeError: 'tuple' object does not
support item assignment
empty = tuple() # Empty tuple
single = (10,) # Single-element tuple. Comma matters!
```

Language Basics

Collections: Dictionary

Dictionaries are **hash maps**.

```
phonebook = {} # Empty dictionary
phonebook = dict() # Also creates an empty dictionary
phonebook = {'Zach': '12-37'} # Dictionary with one item
phonebook['Jay'] = '34-23' # Add another item
print('Zach' in phonebook) >> True
print('Kevin' in phonebook) >> False
print(phonebook['Jay']) >> '34-23'
del phonebook['Zach'] # Delete an item
print(phonebook) >> {'Jay': '34-23'}
```


Language Basics

Loops

To iterate over a list

```
names = ['Zach', 'Jay', 'Richard']  
for name in :  
    print('Hi ' + name + '!')
```

```
>> Hi Zach!  
    Hi Jay!  
    Hi Richard!
```

To iterate over indices and values

One way

```
for i in range(len(names)):  
    print(i, names[i])
```

```
>> 1 Zach  
    2 Jay  
    3 Richard
```

A different way

```
for i, name in enumerate(names):  
    print(i, name)
```

Language Basics

Loops

To iterate over a dictionary

```
phonebook = { 'Zach' : '12-37', 'Jay' : '34-23' }
```

```
for name in phonebook:  
    print(name)
```

```
>> Jay  
     Zach
```

```
for number in phonebook.values():  
    print(number)
```

```
>> 12-37  
     34-23
```

```
for name, number in phonebook.items():  
    print(name, number)
```

```
>> Zach 12-37  
     Jay 34-23
```

Note: Whether dictionary iteration order is guaranteed depends on the version of Python.

Language Basics

Classes

```
class Animal(object):  
    def __init__(self, species, age):  
        self.species = species  
        self.age = age  
  
    def is_person(self):  
        return self.species  
  
    def age_one_year(self):  
        self.age += 1  
  
class Dog(Animal):  
    def age_one_year(self):  
        self.age += 7
```

Constructor `a =
Animal('human', 10)`
Refer to instance with `self`
Instance variables are public

Invoked with `a.is\_person()`

Inherits Animal's methods
Override for dog years

Installing Packages in Python

pip installs Python packages, conda installs packages which may contain software written in any language

Issues may arise when using pip and conda together. **It is best practice to first use conda to install as many packages as possible and use pip to install remaining packages after.** [1]

```
conda install -n myenv [package_name] [=optional version number]
```

Install packages using pip in a conda environment (necessary when package not available through conda)

<code>conda install -n myenv pip</code>	<code># Install pip in environment</code>
<code>conda activate</code>	<code># Activate</code>
<code>myenv pip install</code>	<code>environment #</code>
<code>[package_name] [=optional version number]</code>	<code>Install package</code>
<code>pip install -r <requirements.txt></code>	<code># Install packages from file</code>

[1] <https://docs.conda.io/projects/conda/en/latest/user-guide/tasks/manage-environments.html#using-pip-in-an-environment>

Installing Packages in Python

Importing Package Modules

```
# Import 'os' and 'time' modules
```

```
import os, time
```

```
# Import under an alias
```

```
import numpy as np
```

```
np.dot(x, y)                # Access components with pkg.fn
```

```
# Import specific submodules/functions
```

```
from numpy import linalg as la, dot as matrix_multiply
```

```
# Can result in namespace collisions...
```

Tutorial



Tutorial

1. Install Anaconda referring to the practice materials if you want to use your own PC
 - *Installing Anaconda on Windows*
 - *Installing Anaconda on MacOS*
2. Install the following packages:
 - *NumPy*
 - *Pandas*
 - *Matplotlib*
 - *Seaborn*
 - *Statsmodels*
 - *SciKit-Learn*